

Commercial Launch Plan

A practical roadmap from polished prototype to a dependable, revenue-generating customer channel.

Recommended launch path	Quotation-first, followed by selective ecommerce when operations are ready.
Working format	Markdown master for updates; PDF for meetings and approvals.
Primary owners	Business lead, frontend owner, backend colleague and catalogue owner.

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Purpose: Turn the current prototype into a dependable, revenue-generating commercial website.

Recommended working format: Keep this Markdown file as the editable source of truth. Use the companion PDF for meetings, approvals and sharing.

1. Current position

The storefront now has a substantial catalogue, consistent product cards and product pages, source-checked alarm content, foundational SEO, direct-route handling, a proper 404 page, and automated quality checks.

The site is still best treated as a commercial prototype until the customer journeys that create revenue - quotation, ordering, payment, inventory and fulfilment - are connected to real business systems.

2. Decide the commercial model first

Owner: Boss / business lead

Choose one primary launch model:

- 1. Quotation-first (recommended for the first release):** Customers browse products, request a quote, and staff complete pricing, installation and payment manually. This is the fastest lower-risk route to revenue.
- 2. Full ecommerce:** Customers see live prices and stock, pay online, receive order emails, and enter a fulfilment workflow. This needs considerably more backend, payment, tax and operational work.
- 3. Hybrid:** Standard products can be purchased online; complex kits and installation jobs remain quotation-only.

Record these decisions before backend implementation:

- Products that can be bought online versus quoted
- Retail price, GST treatment and minimum margin
- Delivery areas, freight rules and pickup options
- Installation service areas and pricing method
- Returns, cancellations, warranties and supplier obligations
- Who owns catalogue, pricing, orders, refunds and customer enquiries

3. Launch priorities

P0 - Required before taking real customer orders

Work	Owner	Backend required?	Completion evidence
Choose quotation-first, ecommerce or hybrid	Boss	No	Written decision and product rules
Connect quote and contact forms to a real inbox or CRM	Backend colleague	Yes	Test submission received and acknowledged
Define privacy, terms, returns, shipping and warranty policies	Boss + legal/business adviser	No backend	Approved pages are published
Confirm every displayed price, GST label and stock claim	Catalogue owner	Usually	Sample audit against the source system
Add production authentication only if customer accounts are needed	Backend colleague	Yes	Sign-in, sign-out and account access tested
Implement checkout, payment and order processing if ecommerce is selected	Backend colleague	Yes	Successful test payment, refund and order record
Add inventory and price synchronisation or a documented manual process	Backend colleague + catalogue owner	Usually	No overselling in an end-to-end test

Work	Owner	Backend required?	Completion evidence
Configure transactional email	Backend colleague	Yes	Quote/order confirmation and failure alerts received
Complete accessibility, mobile and cross-browser testing	Frontend owner	No	Test checklist passes
Configure analytics consent and conversion events	Frontend + business	Sometimes	Events verified without collecting unnecessary personal data
Establish backup, logging, error alerts and incident ownership	Backend colleague	Yes	Restore and alert tests completed

P1 - Required for a professional public launch

- Use the final domain and verify HTTPS, redirects, canonical URLs and email-domain records.
- Register Google Search Console and submit the sitemap.
- Configure Google Merchant Center only for products eligible for online purchase or free product listings.
- Complete structured-data checks for products, organisation and breadcrumbs.
- Optimise large JavaScript bundles and product images for Core Web Vitals.
- Test keyboard navigation, focus states, form labels, colour contrast and screen-reader names.
- Test current Chrome, Safari, Edge, iPhone and Android layouts.
- Add clear business identity, contact details, service area and trust information.
- Document who reviews supplier data and how often prices, stock and specifications are refreshed.
- Run a soft launch with staff before paid promotion.

4. Backend colleague handoff

Ask the backend colleague to confirm:

- Current platform, database and hosting responsibilities
- Source of truth for SKU, price, GST, stock and product status
- Quote form endpoint, spam protection, recipient and retention period
- Whether accounts are needed and what customer data will be stored
- Payment provider, webhook handling, refunds and reconciliation
- Cart and order persistence, order numbering and status model
- Delivery calculation, pickup, installation bookings and service areas
- Email provider and templates for quotes, orders, payment and fulfilment
- Admin roles, audit logs and protection of staff routes
- Rate limiting, input validation, secrets management and dependency updates
- Database backups, restore testing, logs, monitoring and incident alerts
- Development, staging and production environments
- API contract and test credentials for frontend integration

Do not send real customer data through placeholder forms while these items remain undecided.

5. Revenue plan

A practical first-stage funnel is:

Search or marketplace listing -> relevant product/category page -> phone call or quote request -> staff qualification -> sale and installation

Focus first on products with clear demand, reliable supply and healthy margin. Each important landing page should answer:

- What is the product or solution?
- Who is it for?
- What is included?
- Is installation available?
- What is the next action: buy, request a quote, call or email?
- Why should the customer trust iSmartTech?

Track gross profit, not only traffic or sales volume.

6. Promotion plan

Owned channels

- Build useful category and product pages around real customer searches.
- Publish practical guides such as choosing camera resolution, wired versus wireless alarms, NVR storage sizing and Auckland installation planning.
- Keep Google Business Profile details, services, photos and reviews current.
- Ask completed customers for genuine reviews.
- Use email follow-up only with appropriate consent.

Search and shopping

- Verify Search Console, submit the sitemap and monitor indexing errors.
- Use Merchant Center free listings for eligible purchasable products.
- Start paid Google Search campaigns only after calls, quote submissions and purchases are measured.
- Send each advertisement to the most relevant product or category page, not automatically to the homepage.

Trade Me

A Trade Me account can be useful as an additional sales channel, especially for known products with clear prices and stock. It should not be the only acquisition strategy.

- Check current Trade Me seller and external-link rules before listing.
- Use consistent titles, SKUs, prices, stock, delivery terms and warranty details.
- Treat marketplace fees as part of product margin.
- Avoid using listings merely to divert buyers away from the marketplace.
- Track marketplace sales separately from direct website sales.
- Begin with a small set of reliable, competitive products and expand only after measuring margin and fulfilment effort.

Local and partner growth

- Create landing pages for Auckland installation services and key service areas.

- Build referral relationships with electricians, builders, property managers and small-business IT providers.
- Use completed installations as case studies only with customer permission.
- Retargeting and social advertising should come after consent, analytics and a proven landing page are ready.

7. Measurement

Configure a simple dashboard with:

- Qualified quote requests
- Quote-to-sale conversion rate
- Online purchase conversion rate
- Phone and email enquiry clicks
- Revenue and gross margin by product/channel
- Customer acquisition cost
- Return on advertising spend
- Cart or quote-form abandonment
- Refund, cancellation and return rate
- Stock accuracy and order fulfilment time
- Organic landing pages, impressions and clicks
- Site errors and failed form/payment events

8. Suggested 30/60/90-day sequence

Days 1-30: Make it operational

- Choose the commercial model.
- Complete the backend handoff.
- Connect quotation/contact processing.
- Approve commercial and privacy policies.
- Verify price, stock, GST and fulfilment rules.
- Finish accessibility, browser and mobile testing.
- Soft-launch to staff and a small customer group.

Days 31-60: Make it discoverable

- Move to the final domain.
- Configure Search Console, analytics and conversion tracking.
- Submit the sitemap and resolve indexing issues.
- Improve priority category and product pages.
- Set up Google Business Profile and review collection.
- Trial a small set of Trade Me listings after policy and margin review.

Days 61-90: Make it scalable

- Add ecommerce only where operations are ready.

- Launch measured search or shopping campaigns.
- Expand content and partner referrals.
- Review conversion, margin and fulfilment data every two weeks.
- Prioritise improvements based on profit and customer friction.

9. Go-live sign-off

The commercial launch is ready only when:

- The commercial model and owners are documented.
- Real quote/order submissions reach the responsible team.
- Pricing, GST, stock, freight and installation rules are verified.
- Privacy, terms, returns and warranty information is approved.
- Direct routes, 404 handling, sitemap and metadata checks pass.
- Accessibility, mobile and cross-browser checks pass.
- Payment and refund tests pass if ecommerce is enabled.
- Transactional emails and failure alerts are received.
- Backups, logs and incident ownership are confirmed.
- Analytics and conversions are verified.
- The final domain, Search Console and sitemap are configured.
- A staff soft launch has completed without critical issues.

10. Immediate next meeting

Schedule a 45-minute meeting with the boss, backend colleague and catalogue owner. Leave the meeting with:

1. The selected commercial model
2. Named owners for each P0 item
3. A backend integration scope
4. A target soft-launch date
5. A decision on the first products and channels to promote